

he date and time

- creating the agenda

1. In the meeting, please allow us to introduce ourselves and our service:
 - it's better for the ASE and their manager to be the ones to describe how we will work with the customers and to begin the process of setting expectations
1. Please understand that the ASE needs to have a full, hour-long meeting for the full ASE service kickoff, and so it's our expectation that there will actually be either one or two kickoff meetings:
 1. If the ASE service was sold as a standalone, there will only be one meeting
 - The ASE will facilitate this meeting
 - The ASE will base the agenda off of the Introductory Meeting template
 - We welcome Account Team participation in the meeting so that you can stay well informed about the ASE's work and also so that the customers can see that we really are a team.
 1. If the ASE service was bundled, there will be two kickoff meetings:
 - In the first meeting, we will introduce ourselves and the service briefly, and we will mention that there will be a second meeting
 - The second meeting will be conducted as described above, with the ASE facilitating and the agenda being based off the Introductory Meeting template

New ASE introductory meeting

When it becomes necessary to introduce a new ASE to an established ASE account, such as when the existing ASE moves into a new role, we will want to host an abbreviated kickoff-style meeting. In this meeting:

1. The new ASE will build the agenda with a focus on the first two main items in the Introductory Meeting template
1. We will ask that the CSA participate in the meeting in order to help the transition to be as smooth as possible. This also provides an opportunity for the CSA and ASE to ensure that they know the customer's GitLab plans and internal stakeholders. Other Account Team members are welcome to attend as well.
1. The new ASE's manager will participate in order to address any concerns the customers may have.

Day-to-day Partnership

1. Please keep ASEs informed about regular and one-off meetings you have with, or about, their customers so that they may decide which ones to attend.
1. Please get to know the ASEs who support your accounts and work with them to gain alignment on how you'll work together. Agreeing on what and how to communicate with each other is particularly important for our mutual success. Consider scheduling a coffee chat to have an informal conversation with an ASE as well.

1. Please be careful not to label an ASE. For example, when first introducing an ASE to a customer, you might say "Tanuki is a database expert." That labels the ASE as a database expert, and suggests that they have no other expertise.
1. When a customer is asking about what an ASE can or can't do, or will or won't do, please let the ASE or their manager answer that question. If it turns out from our answer that you had a different expectation, we can discuss that internally and get realigned.
1. Please trust in Support. If an ASE customer is upset about anything related to the ASE or the service, please listen to and document the customer's concerns, and share your faith and trust in us. Afterward, discuss the concerns with the ASE and, if needed, their manager.

SECTION: support/enhanced-support-offerings/offering-assigned-support-engineer/working-with-ases/global-support-and-ases.md

Global Support working with ASEs

ASEs rely on other SEs to help with their accounts and tickets in a number of different situations. To be sure that you are able to contribute well when you encounter one of these situations, please familiarize yourself with the information presented on this page.

Contributing to ASE tickets

New non-emergency tickets

For many ASE accounts, all new, non-emergency tickets are automatically assigned to their ASE.

Check the org note that is automatically inserted into each ticket to determine whether tickets for that account are automatically assigned, and how you can contribute.

See what to do when the ASE is unavailable and what to do if they came in requesting a different region.

New emergency tickets

Regardless of when an emergency request is submitted by an ASE's account, the DRI

for the emergency is the on-call support engineer.

The only process change is that the on-call support engineer should notify the ASE. The best way to do this is simply to ping the ASE's Slack handle in the emergency's Slack thread. After that, the on-call engineer should work the emergency in the normal way.

Guidance for ASEs regarding emergencies from their accounts can be found on the

ASE emergencies page

Pre-ASE tickets

Tickets that predate the introduction of an ASE for an account are treated a little differently because of their individual histories. Let the customer decide who they'd like to work on this problem with - the existing assignee or the ASE. If they'd like the ASE to own it, then the current assignee and the ASE should communicate with each other so the ASE knows the history of the problem handled in the ticket, the customer's expectations, and anything else the current assignee would find useful to share.

When the ASE is unavailable

An ASE can be unavailable for a variety of reasons such as being off or having a different Support priority at the moment. When that happens and you notice a ticket of theirs that will breach or was missed, feel free to respond to that ticket yourself, but be sure to leave the ASE as the assignee and cc yourself until they return. Upon their return, they'll take the ticket.

Tickets in a different region

Tickets in a different region will still get assigned to the ASE. If they'll breach before the ASE gets online then that means the ASE is unavailable so follow this process.

Covering for an ASE when they are absent

When an ASE is planning time off, they will first find one or more other support engineers to take care of their accounts during their absence. The ASEs use their PTO planning workflow for arranging coverage. Here's what covering for an ASE means for you:

- Balance your workload to make room for the potential work with the ASE accounts. Specifically, decrease your non-ASE ticket work by 25% for each account you cover.
- You would be responsible only for working tickets for the accounts, and not for performing any proactive work, attending any regularly-scheduled meetings, or doing other non-ticket work.
- Configure Zendesk to notify you when new tickets are opened for each account (the ASE will help you to do this).
- Expect to be pinged by the on-call team when any emergencies come in for the accounts. You don't have to take the emergency, but be prepared to offer any information you have to help the on-call engineer in for the accounts.
- If you will cover two or more accounts, please work with your manager to find another engineer to take over your on-call.
- Review each account with the ASE before their absence:
 - For each active ticket, be sure you understand the history and the next steps. Additionally, add yourself to the Cc list.

- Ask the ASE to tell you who the important internal and external contacts are, and how best to work with them
- Ask the ASE to summarize the account's GitLab environment and to share any available document, issues, or other resources that are relevant for working on tickets.
- When the ASE returns, meet with them to review the work you did on their behalf, and to transfer to them any tickets that were opened during their absence as needed.

SECTION: support/internal-support/_index.md

Overview

The purpose of this page is to direct GitLab team members outside of Support on what GitLab Support does, how to get in contact with us, and where to direct common requests that require our involvement. Are you a customer looking for technical support? If so, please visit the Support Page instead.

Quick reference

If it's not mentioned on this page, it's probably not Customer Support.

Please read the next sections on GitLab Support's Purpose and Should I Contact GitLab Support? section for more information.

| Problem | What to do |

| ----- | ----- |

| I want to see tickets | Get a Light Agent ZenDesk account. |

| My customer can't open a ticket (or they get closed) | Make sure they are a support contact. Or maybe, they can't log into ZenDesk. |

| Customer is asking about a ticket | Check the status of the ticket in Zendesk with your Light Agent account. Reach out to the assigned Support Engineer, or add an internal note with the customers ask. If there is a need, you can open a Support Ticket Attention Requestion (STAR). If no ticket, open one .|

| My customer has an emergency! | The customer must send a new email (internal) to trigger an emergency. If not an emergency, you can STAR it. |

| My customer has a subscription / license issue | If a ticket with the customer is not possible, open an internal request. |

This is not an exhaustive list. For anything else you believe the Support team covers, please check the table of contents or search this page.

GitLab Support's Purpose

GitLab Support provides technical support for GitLab.com and Self-Managed GitLab customers. We do not provide support for GitLab team members who are experiencing IT (1Password, Slack, Mac, etc.) issues. If you require assistance with issues of that nature, please contact Team Member

Enablement.

Should I Contact GitLab Support?

For general questions regarding GitLab ("Can GitLab do x?", "How do I do y with GitLab?") please ask in questions, or if you think you've encountered a bug or something isn't behaving right while using GitLab try asking in is-this-known. Doing so ensures that everyone can contribute to an answer.

GitLab Support's Slack channels are specifically for the various GitLab Support teams, not for questions about GitLab the product. If you're working with a customer that requires technical support, please advise them to contact GitLab Support.

Support Team Meta Project

If you'd like to ask a longer term or larger scope question, propose an idea to GitLab Support, discuss something with us, or suggest an improvement or change to any of our workflows, please visit the issue tracker of the Support Team Meta project and create an issue there. Please keep in mind that it is open to the community and as such should not contain any sensitive information, so links to Zendesk or other references are encouraged.

Support Tickets & Customer Information

Requesting Support for Customers

If your customer contacts you requiring technical support, the following options are available to you:

1. (Recommended) In most cases, please direct them to open a ticket through the Support Portal. It is Support's primary function to provide technical support for our customers, and as paid users, they are entitled to access to us. This option is recommended as the customer is best positioned to describe their own issue and needs. Ensure that the customer understands that it will almost always be the fastest path to response to reach out to Support directly.

1. When directing your customer to the GitLab Support Portal, please inform them that they should ensure they have been added as a support contact for their organization otherwise their tickets may be auto-closed (except for Licensing and Renewals tickets). Aligned with this, if your customer requires their colleagues to be able to also submit a support ticket then will also need to provide a list of managed contacts. A customer can add or manage support contacts by following the inscriptions in Managing contacts. Please note that encouraging customers to have a valid support portal account will help streamline the support process and ensure a smoother experience for both the customers and our support team.

1. To request adjustments to licenses, subscriptions, renewals, trials, trial extensions, temp licenses, etc., you can open an Internal Request on behalf of the customer (more details below).

- Note: If the customer already has a license/subscription, and is getting errors while applying it, it's best for the customer to open a Support ticket directly with us.

- Note: To submit the form you must have a Zendesk Light Agent account, which all GitLab team members can request. The account also enables team members to see customer tickets in

Zendesk, and leave notes for the Support team.

1. In sensitive cases where asking a customer to open a ticket would aggravate a situation, you can open a Support ticket on behalf of the customer.

- Note: You cannot be logged into Zendesk if you choose this option, because Zendesk automatically closes any tickets submitted with gitlab.com email addresses. Instead, use a private/incognito window in your browser to submit the ticket. When submitting the ticket, in the "Your email address" field, enter your customer's email address. If you should be CC'd on the ticket, please request it in the ticket body.

External customers should not be cc'd on Internal Requests. Communication with Customers is only provided through Support tickets initiated by the Customer themselves, or tickets opened on their behalf.

Support does not action out of Slack

For questions about specific customer situations, we need a support ticket (from the customer) or an internal request ticket (from a GitLab team member).

There are several reasons why Support cannot respond to customer-specific requests made through Slack:

- We aim to meet the Service Level Agreement (SLA) each time we help a customer, and we only track SLA compliance via Zendesk.
- Zendesk has a ticket assignment system which is vital to our workflow. We have no system to assign tickets in Slack.
- When we are trying to solve a current customer problem, we frequently search resolved tickets in Zendesk. Since Slack content is deleted after 90 days, we may lose valuable information if a customer's problem and/or the solutions to it are discussed in Slack instead of a Zendesk ticket.
- We want to keep all of our records of a customer's technical support problems and their solutions in a single place (Zendesk).

If you want to request that we place additional attention on an existing ticket or internal request, please use the Support Ticket Attention Request Form (handbook entry).

Requesting support for GitLab.com users that have account or login issues

GitLab.com users that have account or login issues should open a new ticket. They should select "GitLab.com (SaaS) User Accounts and Login Issues" as the reason for the request.

If a customer cannot login to GitLab Support Zendesk / customer portal

Customers having difficulty logging into the Zendesk customer portal should first try our documented troubleshooting steps. These steps almost always resolve the difficulty.

If those tips do not resolve the problem, you can open an Internal Request > Other on their behalf.

Requesting to see Customer Information

According to our privacy policies, Support does not provide any information regarding customers, groups, projects, etc, to you that are not available publicly. This includes situations where a customer is requesting information about their own projects, groups, etc. If they are unable to authenticate, we cannot assume they are who they say they are. If they are locked out, please have them submit a support ticket.

Requesting a ZenDesk 'Light Agent' account

A Zendesk Light Agent account is required to view Support Tickets and can be obtained without manager approval.

To request a Zendesk Global light agent account, please send an email to contact-project+gitlab-com-gl-security-corp-cust-support-ops-zendesk-global-lig-68900149-issue-@incoming.gitlab.com.

- You must send your request from your GitLab Google / Gmail account. No other addresses will work.
- Please use gmail to send this. Other email clients often strip vital information from the email headers.
- The Subject should be along the lines of "Light Agent Provisioning".
- The Body should be along the lines of "Light Agent Provisioning".

This will create an issue via Service Desk (which you will be notified about). An automated process will take it from there to setup the Zendesk light agent account.

Once set up, it takes up to 24 hours for your account to be assigned to Zendesk Global in Okta.

Once Zendesk is assigned, you should be able to log in.

If your account is not assigned within 24 hours, please reach out via the Service Desk issue.

Note that you cannot send public replies to customers with a Light Agent account. If you need to do this, please submit a new Access Request issue for a paid full agent account and tag your manager for budget approval. If needed, you can read more information on Light Agent accounts from Zendesk.

Common Requests

Regarding GitLab Support, Plans, and Namespaces

Request	What To Do
Upgrade Assistance	Global organizations: Review the offering, then open a new ticket in the global support portal Public Sector organizations: Open a ticket in the U.S. Government support portal
Who is on-call for Customer Emergencies?	Run <code>/chatops run oncall support</code> in a direct message to GitLab Chatops and review the results. This will not page the on-call engineer.
Who is on-call for GitLab.com CMOC?	Run <code>/chatops run oncall cmoc</code> in a direct message to

GitLab Chatops and review the results. This will not page the on-call engineer. |
Excessive reCaptcha on GitLab.com	While it's happening, post in supportgitlab-com and link to the issue/MR in question to be added to the allowlist.
Report complaints about support that you received from a client or prospect	Open an issue using the Indirect Feedback template.
See if an inactive GitLab.com Namespace can be claimed	If you are a GitLab team member requesting on behalf of a customer, please use the GitLab Support Form and select Namesquatting Requests as the Problem Type. Prospects, free users and GitLab team members do not qualify for name squatting requests.

GitLab plan or license for team members

For local or sandbox testing purposes, GitLab team members can provision their own enterprise edition licenses. Steps to do this:

1. Sign in to the staging Customers Portal by selecting the Continue with GitLab.com account button. If you do not have an existing account, you are prompted to create one.

1. Visit the purchase page for the subscription you'd like to select. The staging Customers Portal links will redirect to a pricing page, so you must navigate directly to the purchase URL. The full list of URLs for staging subscriptions are documented here. If you aren't sure which subscription you'd like, Self-Managed Ultimate is a good default.

1. Purchase the subscription using a test credit card.

Note that both this is a staging license, so you must configure your GitLab instance to use the staging Customers Portal. For an Omnibus install, here is how you point to staging Customers Portal. For GDK, set export CUSTOMERPORTALURL=https://customers.staging.gitlab.com in env.runit.

If for some reason self-provisioning is not working, team members should request a license via the Support Super Form by selecting "Request a team member license" from the drop down options.

If a GitLab team member would like an Ultimate license for GitLab.com, there are two options:

1. Request an Ultimate group license for demo purposes through an access request.
1. Request an Ultimate license for your personal namespace.

Contacting users about GitLab incidents or changes

You can request Support to contact GitLab.com users on your behalf. Here are some cases when you can request us to contact users:

- you believe the planned production changes to GitLab will have a high impact on users and/or create numerous inbound tickets
- you need to inform customers of an urgent Security related issue
- you've blocked a user on GitLab.com
- you need to interview a specific account because they are exhibiting atypical usage patterns or behaviors
- there are important project/group affecting changes
- there are GitLab.com account problems

Request questions	What To Do	Where to ask
-----	-----	

	Contact a user during an incident	Open a confidential infra issue, assign it to the current CMOC, use confidentialincidentdata template supportgitlab-com
	Contact a single user	Open an issue using the Contact Request template supportgitlab-com
	Prepare Support for changes (with or without contacting select users)	Open a Support Preparedness issue supportleadership
	I need to reach out to many users	Open a Marketing-Ops issue supportleadership

Please note: This is not for marketing or sales related contact. This channel is only for communication with users regarding important items that might affect their usage of GitLab SaaS.

Internal Requests

All internal requests regarding licensing, subscriptions, trials, and grace period extensions should be filed using the GitLab Support Internal Request form. Customers should not be cc'd on Internal Requests.

Internal Request SLO

<details><summary markdown='span'>Click for details</summary>

For internal requests, our SLO varies depending on the selected Priority for the ticket. Please select the appropriate priority for each request, using the following information as your guide:

Urgent

- SLO: 1 hour
- Criteria: service loss
- Common Scenarios:
 - SaaS group downgraded
 - SM license expired and grace period exhausted

High

- SLO: 4 hours
- Criteria: time sensitive tasks
- Common Scenarios:
 - Customer will lose SaaS service today
 - SM license grace period will end today

Normal

- SLO: 8 hours
- Common Scenarios:

- SaaS namespace association
- SM license troubleshooting
- Purchasing problems resulting in blockage such as:
 - CI minutes fully exhausted
 - SaaS storage is inaccessible because a project is locked
 - SM renewal period is ending and the customer is facing a purchasing error or problem

Low

- SLO: 24 hours
- Common Scenarios:
 - Purchasing problems with no immediate blockage, e.g. several days are available for resolution
 - Contact management
 - Account management
 - Request to contact sales
 - Pass to billing/AR
 - Reset max seats
 - Order Management tickets
 - Cloud license exemption, resend license, forward license
 - Unless customer is fully blocked / previous license fully expired
 - Trials (start / extend)
 - Requests from sales to increase CI quota / storage quota
 - QSR / billable users disputes or request for more info
 - Educational, product / process questions
 - Community / NFR licenses or subscriptions
 - Non-customers

All of the SLOs apply to business days (24x5) only.

</details>

Extending the grace period on a subscription

Grace period extensions are treated similarly to trial extensions for both Self-managed and GitLab.com SaaS. To request these, file a request using the GitLab Support Internal Request form with the correct option as highlighted in the sections above.

Please consider the following:

1. To extend a trial, a previous trial needs to exist for the customer. If no trial was created at any point, a trial should be created by the customer the day after the plan expires.
1. We can provide grace period extensions as long as the current plan is not ongoing. In other words, if the plan expires on the 15th, we can increase the grace period starting the next day (16th). Please plan accordingly.

Obtaining Proof of Delivery for a Subscription

A copy of the license email sent to the customer is automatically logged under the Activity History of the Sold To Contact in SFDC when a subscription is created. Note that this will be a replica of the email the customer receives, but with the actual license key/activation code removed for compliance purposes. The subject line will begin with [GitLab Transactions].

</details>

I Want to Escalate a Ticket

To keep the term "escalation" MECEFU, Support uses the term "support ticket attention request" (STAR) to make sure account escalations are distinct. "Escalation" can also be confused with "emergency" or "incident."

Please open a support ticket attention request, during GitLab Global Support Hours only, if any of these are true:

- progress in the ticket has stalled and the ticket needs more support engineering effort
- the priority of the ticket has changed (Low -> High)
- the ticket requires immediate intervention to address a high level of customer dissatisfaction
- Support Management oversight is required in order to bring structure and focus to the situation

More about support ticket attention requests

Please open an account escalation if:

- There is account level risk because of a single ticket or an aggregation of several issues.
- Visibility and attention from multiple departments is required to restore customer confidence and resolve the issue.

More about account escalations

Please open an emergency ticket if:

- a customer is facing a situation that meets our Definitions of Support Impact for "Emergency"

More about how Support Engineers handle emergency tickets

Please declare a GitLab.com incident if:

- you've noticed a common pattern of reported problems between SaaS customers
- you've experienced and verified a loss of functionality over a period lasting more than 5 minutes
- you suspect a high severity bug has been deployed to GitLab.com

More about GitLab.com incidents

Please declare a security incident if:

- you have information about a critical issues that may affect the confidentiality, integrity, or availability of GitLab services or data

More about Security incidents

I want to make a change to a setting in the GitLab.com Admin interface

The Infrastructure team is the admin of GitLab.com, and any changes to product tuneables go through the change request workflow.

Trials and Prospect Support

For information relating to priority prospects, please see
Priority Prospects.

My customer is having trouble applying their GitLab.com subscription

The customer has more than likely run into an issue during the purchase process, or is unaware how to apply their subscription to their group. The following documentation outlines how to subscribe to GitLab.com, link their GitLab.com account to CustomersDot, and apply that subscription to their group.

- Obtain a GitLab Subscription
- Manage Your GitLab Account

Users in an account I own would like more visibility into their organization's support tickets

In some cases, certain organizations want all members of their organization to be able to see all of the support tickets that have been logged.

In other cases, a particular user from the account would like to be able to see and respond to all tickets from their organization.

If you'd like to enable this, please:

1. Ask the customer to submit a Support ticket using the Support Ops form and select Shared organization requests in the Problem type field.
1. Once the ticket is created, Support Ops will review and work on the ticket.

Note: If a customer submits a shared organization request using a different Support form, simply change the form to Support Ops and select Shared organization requests in the Problem type field. Support Ops will then review the ticket and ask any followup questions if necessary.

My customer needs a report of all the users within their group(s) structure

To view the group's number of billable members, a member of the group with Owner permissions may visit the Settings -> Billing section of it to see a breakdown. The number of billable

members is the amount listed under Seats currently in use and this is the amount that will come up whenever they link their group to a paid subscription. Billable members consist of every user who is added to a group, subgroup, or project within a paid namespace with the only exception being Guest users within a namespace on certain subscription levels.

We have a billable members API endpoint that will produce a list of all the billable members for the group. This must be run with your own PAT.

All the billable members are also currently displayed on the group billing page in an unsorted list. This is a first iteration; if interested, you can view the epic to see the planned work. If you have any feedback on the billable members list or want to request functionality or UI changes that are not planned in the epic, please feel free to leave a comment on the epic.

I want to add important information about the organization/user

Zendesk has the ability to store Organization and User notes. Using Zendesk triggers, we put these into each ticket submitted by that organization or user. If there is important information you wish to have included in tickets for an organization or user, please create an MR by searching for the organization's ID (you can locate this by copying the ID from the organization's URL in Zendesk) here and making the required changes to the relevant organization's file. Please be sure to indicate whether the information is only valid for a specific period of time so that we may include that fact in the notes.

Examples of some notes you might want added:

- You want to put the SA's name on there for use in the tickets.
- A customer prefers specific titles be used when addressing them.
- An organization has multiple subscriptions.

SECTION: support/internal-support/support-ticket-attention-requests.md

Overview

This document outlines the process for managing support tickets that, due to the situation that is critical for the customer's business, require our attention or an initial response more quickly than what is defined in our standard response time..

What is a Support Ticket Attention Request (STAR)?

Support Ticket Attention Requests (STAR) are the mechanism by which GitLab Team Members can request additional attention be placed on tickets. Feel free to pronounce the acronym STAR, and use it as a verb (I starred this ticket because of a request from the customer) or a noun (I put a star on this ticket to make sure an engineer with the right expertise is assigned).

The following two types of tickets can have additional attention requested using this process:

1. Zendesk Support tickets from a customer with a license or subscription.

1. Internal Requests in Zendesk created by a GitLab team member for a customer with a license or subscription.

>Please use the STAR process instead of posting in Slack channels. Requesting eyes on, asking for an immediate opinion on, or requesting additional attention for a ticket, in any Support-related Slack channel, creates unnecessary stress on Support Engineers who may be working on other priority tickets.

Once submitted, an issue is created in the Support Ticket Attention Request issue tracker. The issue is automatically assigned to the Support Manager on-call.

When you STAR a ticket, a thread is created in the supportticket-attention-requests Slack channel.

When should you STAR a ticket?

1. When management oversight is required to bring structure and focus to a ticket, and ensure the necessary resources are allocated to it. For example, if:

- The first-response SLA of the ticket has been breached by one hour or more (see Before you STAR a ticket).

- The ticket requires immediate intervention to address a high level of customer dissatisfaction.

- The ticket requires increased attention from the support team due to business reasons, even if it hasn't breached the SLA yet.

- The ticket's priority is objectively lower when assessed in relation to the Support Impact guidelines.

1. When the progress of a ticket has stalled, and the ticket needs to be elevated to a different engineer (based on their skill set) so that GitLab can resolve the ticket more quickly.

When is a STAR not appropriate?

1. It is a business-critical situation for GitLab where existing or future business is at risk so attention from CSM is needed -> raise an account escalation

1. It is an emergency -> Advise the customer to raise an emergency (internal Handbook link, GitLab team members only; only Premium/Ultimate customers are eligible to trigger emergencies)

1. It is a SaaS incident -> check the GitLab Status Page or report an incident

1. You want to pass additional information to the engineer working on the ticket --> Leave an internal note in the ticket in Zendesk or reach out to the Support Engineer working the ticket in a Slack channel like supportgitlab-com or supportself-managed.

Before you STAR a ticket

>IMPORTANT: Please be available in Slack after submitting a STAR request, in case the Support Manager has questions for you.

Check that the ticket meets basic eligibility for STAR treatment:

1. A relevant Support Engineer (who replied previously, left a substantial note, etc.) was contacted via Slack but did not reply.

1. Is the ticket about L&R (subscription, plan, renewal, licensing, trials)? Please see our Workflow for handling Plan/License Ticket Attention Requests and its decision flowchart. Requests for customer convenience (that is, when a loss of functionality is not imminent) may not be prioritized.

- L&R STAR requests must include all relevant information, like group name, subscription name, license holder.

1. Are we waiting for information from the customer, or from you? Ensure the latest response is from the customer (or from a GitLab team member, in the case of Internal Requests). If the latest response is from GitLab Support, we are waiting for necessary information.

1. Is the ticket within SLA? Review the SLA associated with the ticket, and the amount of time left until breach, by logging into Zendesk using Okta.

- If a ticket was opened in the last 0-30 minutes, and has the correct Severity, a STAR request is not necessary.

- It is not typically necessary to STAR an issue that has multiple hours remaining on the SLA timer.

- Our SLAs apply to first-responses to tickets. GitLab Support targets a 95% SLA achievement KPI. This means that some breaching is expected.

- If the ticket has already had the first reply, then you are looking at a possible "internal (next reply) breach", for which there are no contractual SLAs.

- If you make a STAR request when a ticket is still within SLA, the Support Manager will discuss with you the best approach.

1. Is the ticket missing information?

- If a ticket doesn't have all the necessary information it won't qualify for STAR, for example:

- A log was requested but not provided by the customer.
- 2FA requests without all the necessary challenges completed.
- Unanswered questions asked by Support Engineer in the ticket.
- Proof of support entitlement

Note: You cannot use the Internal Request Form without a Zendesk account. If you do not have Zendesk access, please request a Light Agent account to obtain it.

Out of Scope / Ineligible for STAR treatment

1. Topics that fall into our general out-of-scope definition.

1. Tickets for which there is no acceptable business-case provided that justifies additional attention.

1. Tickets missing the customer Organization information ("Needs Org"). Instead: Review requirements in our Needs Org workflow, and ping in the supportoperations Slack channel.

1. Tickets that do not appear to have the correct SLA assigned to them. Instead: Review requirements in our SLA workflow, and ping in the supportoperations Slack channel.

Submitting a Support Ticket Attention Request (STAR) / Starring a ticket

Important

The Zendesk STAR App is available only during our Global Support Hours; outside of these hours it will be disabled.

Via the Zendesk STAR app

To access, click on the Apps button located in the top right of the page (underneath your profile icon). When you click on it, it will expand to show the STAR form within Zendesk.

When you use this method, the app automatically acquires most of the required information directly from the ticket. That's a lot less work for you, and you can be assured that the data will already be validated before it is sent to the Support Managers for evaluation.

You will only need to provide:

- Urgency
- Plan
- GitLab.com group URL or name
- Reason this ticket needs additional attention
- Desired result

Here is how the form will appear in the Zendesk App:

Validation

The Zendesk STAR App will automatically validate the following before submitting the request:

- The submission time is within Support hours
- A valid namespace is entered (SaaS and SaaS Account forms only)
- The ticket was created more than 30 minutes ago
- The ticket is using a valid support form (SaaS, SaaS Account, Self-Managed, L&R, Open Partner, Select Partner, Alliance Partner)

Definition of STAR Urgency Levels

NOTE: These definitions determine how the STAR request is handled; they do not refer to the Impact / Urgency / Severity of the underlying problem described in the ticket itself.

| Urgency Level | Definition |

|-----|-----|

| Not Urgent | We need increased visibility on the ticket/issue and a response from Support within the next 2 hours. This request for attention is not urgent, and the overall impact is low.|

| Timely | We need to address potential or existing customer dissatisfaction on the ticket/issue with a response from Support within the next 1 hour. This escalation has a certain level of urgency, and the overall impact is medium.|

| Urgent | The ticket/issue may become an emergency if no follow-up is provided within the next 30 minutes and may lead to customer dissatisfaction. This escalation is urgent, and the overall impact is high.|

STAR Issue Tracker

Once submitted, an issue is created in the Support Ticket Attention Request issue tracker. The issue is automatically assigned to the Support Manager on-call and logs the ticket attention request.

Unstarring a ticket (Support use only)

Depending on the request, the Support Manager on-call may decide that a STAR is without merit. Please be aware that we take into consideration the current state of the entirety of the ticket queue, and already existing STARs, when determining the appropriate prioritization for your STAR request.

When unstarring a ticket, the manager must set expectations with the requester by documenting the following in the STAR Issue:

1. Reasons why the ticket does not qualify for STAR treatment.
1. Agreement with requester on an acceptable alternative path.

Every STAR that is unstarred must include the unstarred label on the corresponding Issue.

Redirecting Ticket Attention Requests (Support Use Only)

If a STAR request is posted in the wrong Slack channel, add the :support-ticket-attention-request: emoji as a reaction to the post. The user will be advised of the proper way to request a Support Ticket Attention Request via a Slack Workflow.

SECTION: support/knowledge-base/_index.md

The knowledge base (KB) is a repository of solutions to commonly-encountered problems, created and maintained by Support Engineers (SE).

The knowledge base turns the effort used to solve a single ticket for one customer into a public resource for all GitLab users.

Benefits:

- Deflects ticket creation.
- Resolves user problems faster.
- Creates consistent, standard answers.
- Creates an environment of trust.
- Gives Support more time to focus on harder issues or improvements.

Principles

- Turn it into a habit. If the issue is worth solving, it is worth saving.
 - Start a knowledge article every time you solve a problem for a customer, a team member or yourself.
- Accelerate knowledge capture. Our tools and processes should enhance the speed at which we add knowledge to the Knowledge Base.

- Capture Knowledge in the moment when the context is clearest and we are able to access customer feedback.
- Provide feedback as soon as possible if you find a better way to do something.
- Capture customer context. Prioritize capturing the right knowledge, in the context of the customer.
 - Focus on documenting the errors and issue as described by the customer for improved findability from other users.
 - Include clear steps and context when documenting solutions. When in doubt, ask, would Josh Darnit be able to do it?
- Always be iterating. The Knowledge Base is as much for us as for our customers. We review and update knowledge as we use and reuse it.
 - Reuse is Review: We improve the quality of our knowledge by always iterating.

How Knowledge Articles differ from GitLab docs

The Knowledge Base and our product documentation are both key elements of GitLab's digital support experience that serve different needs

Docs

Docs answer: "How does this work?"

- Teaches about product features and how to use them.
- Provides an overview of the current version of our products.

Knowledge Articles

Knowledge Articles answer: "How do I fix this?"

- Solves problems encountered while using our products.
- Includes solutions to problems in past versions of our products.

Why you should create a knowledge article

Knowledge articles help users to do tasks, get answers to questions and fix issues they may encounter while using our products.

Creating a clear, well-written knowledge article empowers customers to solve issues on their own and helps Support Engineers quickly access accurate, consistent information. Knowledge articles build trust and ensure reliable, repeatable support experiences.

We use types of knowledge to efficiently provide the information for our end users. This includes:

- How-To
- Break/Fix
- FAQ (Question and answer)
- Troubleshooting

When to create a knowledge article

In short, you should create an article when someone will benefit from the information.

Some questions to consider:

- Will it help customers find information quickly?
- Does it answer a common question / issue?
- Does it document a repeatable way to do something?
- Would this information help a customer get what they need without Support intervention?
- Is this information that may need frequent updates?
- Is this a new issue (with or without a solution) that may cause an influx of support tickets?

What Training is Available for Knowledge Articles in ZenDesk?

A list of available training can be found in Knowledge Base Training Resources.

Implementation

We use ZenDesk to create, modify, and publish knowledge base articles.

Knowledge base articles are dynamically suggested to a user while submitting a ticket.

Integrating with Zendesk offers the following benefits:

- Centralized Knowledge Base
- Scalable and Customizable
- Seamless Integration with Tickets
- Improved Support Engineer Productivity
- Streamlined Analytics and Reporting
- Streamline "Knowledge Centered Service" (KCS), adopting knowledge into the workflow

Knowledge base articles can be found at:

- Global support knowledge base
- US Government support knowledge base

Please Note: US Government articles as of May 2, 2025 are no longer updated to be consistent with the Global Support Site. No new articles will be available on the US Government page until a later date. Date TBD.

Roles and Permissions

There are three roles: Support Engineer, Knowledge Champions and Knowledge Admins.

- Support Engineers: Create, update and use KB articles in tickets.
- Knowledge Champions: Review, publish, archive and control permissions.
- Knowledge Admins: Make sure everything runs smoothly.

Most Knowledge Base tasks are performed within the Zendesk platform (Support and Knowledge Portal). However, some tasks by Knowledge Admins will require manual work outside of Zendesk.

{{< cardpane >}}
{{% card header="Knowledge Workers (Support Engineers, Everyone)" %}}

Task	Executed In
Create (draft) articles	Zendesk Knowledge
Modify (update) articles	Zendesk Knowledge
Link Knowledge article in a Ticket	Zendesk Support

{{% /card %}}

{{% card header="Knowledge Champions (Technical Reviewers)" %}}

Task	Executed In
Review/Approve articles	Zendesk Knowledge
Publish articles	Zendesk Knowledge
Create (draft) articles	Zendesk Knowledge
Modify (update) articles	Zendesk Knowledge
Link Knowledge articles in Zendesk ticket	Zendesk Support
Add / Remove Guide Permissions	support-team.yaml See: support-team.yaml docs
Archive articles	Zendesk Knowledge

{{% /card %}}

{{% card header="Knowledge Admins (Customer Support Operations)" %}}

Task	Executed In
Restore articles	Feature Request
Delete articles	Have Knowledge Champion archive, Feature Request Issue to have it permanently deleted
History of articles	Zendesk Knowledge (Changelog, available to everyone)
Creating permission sets	Feature Request with Customer Support Operations
Create (draft) articles	Zendesk Knowledge
Modify (update) articles	Zendesk Knowledge
Link Knowledge articles	Zendesk Support
Create section	Feature Request with Customer Support Operations
Update section	Feature Request with Customer Support Operations
Delete section	Feature Request with Customer Support Operations

{{% /card %}}

{{< /cardpane >}}

Contributors (Knowledge Workers)

Everyone can contribute to knowledge! The most important thing is to capture the knowledge you've created while solving a problem.

The review process will ensure the content is technically accurate and clear.

Technical Reviewers (Knowledge Champions)

There will be Support Engineers and Support Managers trained as technical reviewers for knowledge articles across the globe.

Available Technical Reviewers (by Geo)

Technical Reviewers should be Subject Matter Experts (SMEs) in certain areas (Such as Runner, Authentication, Migrations, etc.). The Technical Reviewers are tasked with reviewing knowledge articles based on their knowledge of features.

Technical Reviewers perform the following actions.

Responsibilities

Technical Reviewers are expected to:

- Prioritize and Normalize checking the Manage Articles list as part of their daily workflow and routine.
- Collaborate with Knowledge article contributors on the technical accuracy of the content, prioritizing having updates published as soon as possible.
- Technically review knowledge articles and determines if the article can be Published for customers (or should remain internal).
- Understands the material and requirements for the article being published.
- Identify trends and opportunities from reporting.
- Provides feedback for knowledge articles.

Getting Help

Questions can be asked in the dedicated sptknowledge-base Slack channel.

For any issues with permissions, please use the knowledge dedicated Slack channel: sptknowledge-base - and tag or open an Issue and tag {{< member-by-name "Kirsty Allen" >}}.

Using AI to generate content

- ZenDuo can assist with generating a first pass of an article. Always review generated data by Duo for technical accuracy. You are still the subject matter expert (SME) of the article and original customer issue.
- Only use ZenDuo or Duo chat when providing customer data. Other LLM services, such as Claude, are not approved for Red data.

SECTION: support/knowledge-base/kb-faq.md

This section is provided to help guide you through Knowledge article best practices, and address frequently asked questions.

Think about who the intended audience is, for the information. What is the purpose of the information? Can it be easily accessible to a customer? How often is it updated?

As a Best practice: Knowledge articles are more concise, easy to read, targeted for quick

answers, solutions to common questions. Create knowledge articles that can help customers solve issues / problems. Create knowledge articles that are FAQs. Common questions that can be addressed/answered. Create knowledge articles that are frequently updated Create knowledge articles that can be easily accessed by customers (Searchable)

Best Practices:

- Use GitLab Terminology Consistently (Naming Structure).
- Use Proper Templates and Structure when creating articles
- Keep articles clear, and focused.
- Write for Localization (Keep it simple, Write Clearly, and in terms customers can understand/use)
- Maintain Versions (use a label where appropriate)
- Link to other Resources

Note: If customer facing, make sure they can access any links that are within the article. If they cannot, do not add it.

- Categorize articles appropriately. This helps with search!
- Keep articles updated (review). If you find an article that could use more information, updates- do it! We all can contribute to knowledge!
- Titles of articles need to be Specific (Using key words to help be descriptive). Titles should not be log.
- Have a Summary of what the article is about to give an overview of the article.
- Have a Problem statement to help the user understand if it applies to them.
- Have Clear instructions (Bullet Points, Pictures, Details)
- Create the article based on the user context.
- Write for Audience. How will they read it (their words).
- Use Keywords (Content tags) for Search. Search terms pull from Content Tags, Titles and Description of Knowledge articles
- Include Steps for work around, and troubleshooting.
- Include Support information for further help if needed.

Knowledge Base Style Guide

Knowledge slides

Questions & Answers

Who do I contact if I need help with knowledge?

Use the Slack Channel sptKnowledge-base

Where can I find more information about knowledge management and KCS?

There are many slides (with a table of contents) available in Google drive

Is there Training for knowledge creation, modifying and Publishing?

Yes! A list of available training resources is available on the Knowledge Base training page](./knowledge-base-training)

How do I become a Knowledge Champion/Technical Reviewer?

Review the Technical Reviewers responsibilities before committing to the role.

Please talk with your manager, and let them know you wish to become a knowledge champion.

Contact {{< member-by-name "Kirsty Allen" >}} to get added to the Technical Reviewer list.

How do I know if I am a Support Engineer or Knowledge Champion in ZenDesk?

View the permission in the Roles and Permissions section.

Who can Approve & Publish my article?

Technical Reviewers will approve and publish articles.

Can I use the "Request Article" feature in the Knowledge section?

Not at this time. Currently the button is enabled, and the information can be filled out, a ticket is created but it will be AUTO CLOSED and an email sent to the requestor. Please use the sptKnowledge-base channel for help creating an article.

What labels can I add?

There are pre-populated labels to choose from, or create your own relevant to the article. Please avoid creating new labels without consulting with {{< member-by-name "Kirsty Allen" >}}.

How do I add internal notes to a knowledge article?

Use the markdown editor in the knowledge article. Add a comment using the comment out syntax (example <! adding notes that are not seen externally>). Comments will not be visible to the end user. For a visual see slide in the knowledge slide here

SECTION: support/knowledge-base/kb-style-guide.md

This document outlines the standards for GitLab Support's Knowledge Base documentation. These articles help address a specific customer issue in the moment and allow them to self-solve or receive quicker solutions when Support is required. The style guide helps ensure that we provide information in a consistent format and voice for our customers.

The Knowledge Base voice

The voice in KB articles should be concise, direct, and precise. Since many users will use these articles during a stressful situation, it is important that we make the information as clear and simple as possible.

Formatting

Follow the Documentation Style Guide and use the recommended word list unless otherwise specified. The important thing is that we deliver clear information following a standard template that customers know they can trust.

Pay special attention to things like:

- Writing for localization
- Capitalization, especially for feature and product names
- Unordered and ordered lists, and when to use each type
- Acronyms

Title

The H1 header becomes the document title in Zendesk. For example:

text

This is the page title

When creating a new KB article from a template, the title must be changed to properly publish the article in Zendesk.

A good title briefly describes the content of the article while remaining concise. Only capitalize the first word and proper nouns, and refer to capitalization in the Documentation Style Guide when in doubt. You can include error snippets if relevant, but keep title length in mind.

In general you should cover:

- Break/fix: The symptoms customers will see when they encounter an issue
- How-to: How to complete a specific task
- Q&A: The question a customer may have

Examples:

- Break/fix: 504 Gateway timeouts and performance degradation after losing PostgreSQL nodes
- How-to: How to update the Primary email address of multiple users
- Q&A: What are the required steps to upgrade my environment?

Description

This section describes the symptoms, task, or situation that would need a solution. At the moment, we believe the first 140 characters will be indexed for search engine optimization (SEO).

- Write for the issue encountered, not theoretical situations. Add unconfirmed situations as an additional note if necessary.
- Entries should be listed in order of significance from top to bottom.
- Include as much relevant context as possible. Every small symptom is an extra data point to help the customer self-diagnose.

- Include the exact error or message a user would encounter as text in the description to aid with searchability. Avoid images of error messages.
- Error messages should be put in block quotes.
- Use an unordered list for multiple items.

Environment

The environment quickly highlights what custom configurations, installation types, or versions are relevant to the KB. Be as specific as possible.

- Use an unordered list when possible
- Impacted offerings - aligns with the Offering section of Docs pages
- Impacted versions - highlights affected versions.
 - If the document affects all versions of the product, use your best judgement to either omit the versions section, or state that all versions are affected.
 - Use earlier and later when talking about version numbers.
 - Note the product with the version, like GitLab 17.4.4 or GitLab Runner 14.3.1.
 - Always indicate which patch versions are affected, for clarity. This differs from the Documentation Style Guide.
 - If all patch versions of a minor version are affected, say All GitLab 17.4.x versions.
 - If a fix was backported, say GitLab 17.4.0 to 17.4.6, fixed in 17.4.7. You can repeat this if multiple minor versions are affected.

Some examples:

markdown

- Impacted offerings:
 - GitLab Dedicated
 - GitLab Self-Managed
- Impacted versions:
 - GitLab 16.3.0 to 16.3.7, fixed in GitLab 16.3.8
 - GitLab 16.4.3 to 16.4.5, fixed in GitLab 16.4.8

markdown

- Impacted offerings:
 - GitLab Self-Managed
- Impacted versions:
 - GitLab 17.0.4 and later
- GitLab Geo is configured
- LDAP is configured

markdown

- Impacted offerings:
 - GitLab.com
- Project is configured with SAST scanning

Solutions and workarounds

The solution section clearly lists the steps a user must follow to resolve the issue. You can preface the steps with a high-level summary. If there is a solution and a workaround, add the workaround as a level 3 () sub-heading.

1. Change the title of this section to best fit its content: Solution or Workaround

1. Describe steps needed to resolve or work around the issue. Steps should be as concise as possible. For example:

text

1. On a rails or database node, connect to the database with `sudo gitlab-psql connect`

1. Run:

`pgsql`

--- comment: explain what complicated command does if not obvious

`<complicated command>`

- For different environments, list commands as sub-items:
 - Linux: `<command>`
 - macOS: `<command>`
- Use ordered lists for tasks that must be completed sequentially. Use 1. for all items to allow for steps to be added or removed in the future.
- Use unordered lists for unordered steps.
- Link to pre-existing documentation when possible.

Cause

This section describes what caused the issue to happen and why it was introduced, if known.

The cause does not immediately diagnose or solve the issue, which is why it is a separate section and listed after the description and solution.

If the cause is still under investigation, state that the cause is unknown.

Link to docs, blog posts, issues, and other supporting materials inline as necessary.

Additional information

Providing additional information is optional, but can be useful for sharing related topics that are not addressed in other sections. While most sections should be concise and clear, we can dive deeper into information or steps such as:

- Specific locations of logs, errors, or other data mentioned in the description
- Alternative commands to find information in the solution
- Related feature requests worth upvoting

Related links

Optional. Add links to relevant feature requests, bug issues, or other info as necessary.

Follow the format used for related topics.

Even when links have been included inline in other sections, it's useful to consolidate the links in one section as well, for quick reference.

Integrate pre-existing documentation when possible

We should strive to re-use existing documentation when possible. If steps to a solution already exist within our documentation or another KB, link to that section and provide additional steps and context to the KB as necessary. Any newly found steps to a pre-existing solution should be merged into that solution and referenced in the new article.

Examples:

- Update to Solution to link to a doc rather than duplicating information
- Discussion on whether to update steps in the KB or in Docs

SECTION: support/knowledge-base/knowledge-base-training.md

The following resources are available.

How-to Videos:

- How to Search for a Knowledge Article within Zendesk
- How to Link Knowledge to a Support Ticket
- How to Modify (Update) a Knowledge Article
- How to Create a Knowledge Article outside a ticket

Training Courses:

- Support Engineer (Knowledge Worker)
- Technical Reviewer (Knowledge Champion)
- How to Review a Knowledge Article
- How to Link a Knowledge Article to a Support Ticket
- How to Change the Folder and Viewing Permissions of a Knowledge Article

SECTION: support/knowledge-base/knowledge-features-roadmap.md

We have features and requests that are being addressed and considered as part of our knowledge article process. These features are collected from feedback from you all, areas we need to see growth in, as well as enhancements that will help knowledge flow.

This table provides an overview of what we are working on IN PROGRESS

Feature	Status	
Notes		

:----- :----- :--		

Local Repository using Markdown. Sync Repository discussions in place	Investigating	
What are we working on for SWIR. Provide more updates weekly bring more awareness, will outline process and add to handbook	In Process	To
Add Internal comments to articles. Currently dont have a way to add. Issue 6883	Investigating	
Markdown not working on copy/paste Investigating how to fix	Investigating	
Update Search Filtrs /streamline. Default to Knowledge articles. Add versions (can we use impacted versions?)	Investigating	
Add Published articles to Slack. Provides notification of published 6925	Change Requested	
US Governmanet knowledge articles. Provide process for how to add 6886	In Process	
Article suggestions in articles (aligned with comments. Need process) Issue 6886	Investigating	
Article Review process for relevancy. Ensures articles are up to date. 6888	Investigating	
KCS Dashboard Metrics Dashboard Created	In Process	
Content Standards. Formatting, Links work, spelling, etc. Issue 6887	Investigating	
Suggest articles BEFORE a customer submits a ticket based on keywords issue to be created.	Investigating	
Add Technical Reviwers to the Skills Page 275	In Progress	
Add Knowledge Base training to the Support Training TBD	Investigating	
Draft article created automatically by a button/api -no touch by SE. 6926	Invesitgating	

Note: For a more Detailed outline of these features read more about them Feature and Status Phase 2

This table provides an overview of what has been COMPLETED

Feature	Status
:-----	
:-----	
Creating knowledge articles in ZenDesk interface	Phase 1 Completed

May 2025	
Knowledge Roadmap Outlined & Shared	Completed May 2025
Technical Reviewers (Knowledge Champions) added with help from managers	Completed May 2025
Support Engineer, Knowledge worker Testing (Sandbox)	Completed May 2025
Knowledge Section of Handbook Updated with all information.	Completed May 2025
Training (all knowledge aspects) created and shared	Completed May 2025
SuperForm and sync repositories deprecated	Removed May 2025

Interested in the Knowledge Management Roadmap?

- Knowledge Roadmap slides

Additional Resources

- Knowledge Management Slides
- Slack Channel

SECTION: support/knowledge-base/knowledge-workflow.md

The Knowledge Workflow is the process of how information flows through - from creation to publish. We capture knowledge, we then create the knowledge, the knowledge gets reviewed, organized, categorized, and then published. The Goal is to create a smooth, efficient flow where valuable knowledge is used by all and not lost (or trapped in someones head). Having the Knowledge workflow helps us to move the Knowledge process easily and efficiently.

Create a Knowledge article

- Draft article is created (using a template)
- Knowledge Article is in Progress
- The Knowledge Team then reviews the article for accuracy. (Is the formatting correct, are there any spelling errors, do the links work)
- The article is then ready to be "Reviewed" by a "Technical Reviewer".
- The article is Published

Note:

- When Creating the knowledge article it should always be in In Progress Status.
- Ready for Review status will be used when assigning to a Technical Reviewer
- Ready to Publish status will ONLY be used for articles that are to be reviewed and ready to be published on a specific date (Example: articles set for product releases)

Modify a Knowledge article

- Article is in Edit status (draft)
- Knowledge Article is in Progress
- Save the article
- The article is then ready to be "Reviewed" by a "Technical Reviewer" (only if major changes. Minor changes it can be Republished)
- The article is Published

Note:

- When Modifying the knowledge article the knowledge article goes back to "Draft". The Current version of the article will remain active on the page. When the draft is published with updates, it will update the page.

Approving and Publishing a Knowledge article

- Article is "Awaiting Review" or "Ready to Publish" status.
- Technical review must be done on the article
- If Changes need to be made, use the Assign to (Round Circle icon near the title). Add comments and assign to the author to make changes.
- Save the article
- If the